Efforts to broad-base economic cooperation come up against fears in the Indian business community of being caught in the complex web of US secondary sanctions against Russia, which are deliberately ambiguous and carry the potent threat of exclusion from the US market. India may have eventually secured American acquiescence to the India–Russia S-400 contract (though even this is contradicted by US statements from time to time), but the Damocles sword of CAATSA hangs over every future "significant" defence transaction with Russia, with "significant" being deliberately left undefined. In many other areas, Russia–US acrimony and US expectations of India will test the vitality of the India–Russia strategic partnership.

Even as an India–Russia dialogue on the Indio-Pacific develops, Russia will continue to worry that the India–US partnership in the region should not progress towards an alliance. Indian concerns include Russia's relations with Pakistan and actions on Afghanistan. Russia–Pakistan relations are acquiring a strong profile, with high-level visits, a defence cooperation agreement, joint military exercises, and some sales of military platforms. India felt that official Russian responses to the terrorist attack in Kashmir (February 2019) and the subsequent Indian airstrike on an alleged terrorist camp in Pakistan underplayed the Pakistani role in the terror attack. In 2017, Russia went to the extraordinary extent of publicly criticising the US administration for its "selective pressure" on Pakistan.[30] India has also had reservations about Russia's dialogues with the Afghan Taliban, with Pakistan's assistance, and the subsequent US–Russia–China–Pakistan coordination, which eventually led to the US–Taliban agreement of February 2020. Contra-examples were Russia's recent support for India's membership of the NSG and the Indian position on its